

Autistic MIRO (m)

Categories Content

Avatar - "Autistic Parent"

Reference: 30-45 parent, child 3-6, diagnosed or suspected ASD, potty training significantly delayed beyond peers

Age: 30-45

Gender: F >>> M

Desire "I just want him to use the toilet."

"I want him out of pull-ups."

"I want daycare/school to accept him."

"I want this not to control our lives anymore."

Core Desire Safety (for her child)

Protection

Dignity

Social acceptance

Competence as a mother

Relief from constant vigilance

Why NOW Child is 3-6 years old and still not trained

School enrollment deadline approaching

Daycare rejection

Public meltdowns with visible pull-ups

Other kids younger already trained

Pediatrician asking questions

Family members making comments

Sibling comparison

She's pregnant again (common in threads)

Financial pressure (pull-ups expensive)

The urgency is social + institutional pressure.

Why NOT before? Autism diagnosis explained delays

Therapists said "don't rush"

Tried child-led approach

Tried structured methods (Oh Crap, timers, schedules)

Tried forcing → caused trauma/regression

Tried rewards → didn't generalize

Tried ignoring → didn't work

Tried sensory accommodations

Tried occupational therapy

Tried social stories

Tried visual schedules

Every attempt either: failed, created regression, caused meltdowns or increased withholding

Now she's exhausted.

Emotions

primary Overwhelmed

"These past three years have been hell."

Secondary: Anxious

"Most traditional methods did not work."

"He would IMMEDIATELY lose it if I suggested it."

"What works for NT kids does not work for mine."

Exhausted

"Nothing works, he just refuses"

Secondary: Hopeless

"I can't describe how many times I've gone on Reddit."

"It's literally driving me insane."

"Nothing was effective."

Frustrated

"Every attempt either failed, created regression, caused meltdowns or increased withholding"

Secondary: Defeated

"He refuses."

"He loses interest almost immediately."

Regressions

Anxious

"My oldest withheld for 9 days."

Secondary: Fear

"The pediatrician was checking in."

"It sounds like the sensory experience is dysregulating for him."

"I'd hate to be making him uncomfortable."

Cautious

"Maybe wait until he's 4."

Secondary: Insecure

"Maybe pull back for now."

"Has he seen an OT?"

"I could be wrong but..."

Determined

"No more diapers/pull ups AT ALL."

Secondary: Pressured

"Commit at least a week."

"Have them completely naked."

"Use rewards with visual aides."

Isolated

"I wish I had read something like this."

Secondary: Lonely

"What works for NT kids does not work for mine."

"Trial and error."

"Searching Reddit for answers."

Behaviors Avoidance:

Avoids public bathrooms

Avoids long outings

Avoids sleepovers

Avoids preschool programs with strict requirements

Coping:

Keeps spare clothes everywhere

Uses overnight pull-ups during day "just in case"

Reminds every 30-60 minutes

Watches child for cues constantly

Explains autism to strangers defensively

Makes jokes about it to reduce tension

Research behaviors:

Googles at 2am: "autistic 5 year old not potty trained"

Searches Reddit threads

Joins autism parent Facebook groups

Screenshots tips but feels overwhelmed

Watches sensory OT content

Reads academic studies

Asks pediatrician repeatedly

Purchasing behaviors:

Buys multiple potty types

Buys visual charts

Buys underwear with favorite characters

Buys reward systems

Buys sensory supports

Buys books about autism & toileting

Returns products that "didn't work"

Demographics

(weakest avatar layer) Female 28-42

Middle income

Often college educated

Actively involved in therapies

Has child with diagnosed ASD (Level 1-3)

Possibly other diagnoses: ADHD, sensory processing disorder

Likely juggling appointments weekly

Often primary caregiver

Language She Uses "He's not ready."

"It's a sensory thing."

"He doesn't feel it."

"He withholds."

"He'll only go in a diaper."

"We tried everything."

"The Oh Crap method traumatized him."

"He melts down if I push."

"He can hold it for hours."

"He doesn't mind sitting in it."

"He won't stop playing."

"Daycare won't take him."

"People think I'm lazy."

"Potty training isn't linear."

"I don't want to force him."

"I don't want to cause trauma."